

# Grant Easel

## ACT I / Before the murder

### Your history with Sterling

Sterling had learned that one certificate in a major private sale you brokered was forged before it ever reached you. He planned to imply publicly that you had created it unless you refunded him millions.

### What you are hiding

You were duped on that sale, but you quietly altered your own file afterward so clients would not see how badly your due diligence failed. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

### Your objectives

- Learn whether Conrad knows about the disputed certificate.
- Keep Theo from discussing the 'auction incident' in public.
- Figure out what Nadia knows about the Geneva freeport records.

### What you know about other guests

- Theo was the anonymous buyer who outbid Sterling in the auction everyone whispers about.
- Conrad arranged at least one unusually discreet private sale for Sterling outside normal auction-house procedure.

*Notes / Who will you speak to first?*

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## **ACT II / After Sterling dies**

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

### **IF INNOCENT**

You entered the Donor Salon at 6:34 to leave an appraisal folder and briefly handled a decorative decanter that looked like Sterling's service piece. From 6:40 to 6:49, the Media Room document terminal shows you revising and reprinting the disputed sale file you secretly altered. The audit trail clears your timing but exposes your cover-up.

### **IF MURDERER**

At 6:43 you returned with a revised appraisal folder. You used the lookalike decanter as cover while slipping the toxin directly into Sterling's silver coupe, then wiped the stem before leaving.

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## **ACT III / Evidence update**

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card B. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card A. Put the unused card away.

### **FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called**

#### **IF INNOCENT**

I altered my own file because I was embarrassed that a forged certificate passed my desk. Sterling was using that mistake to extort a refund and my silence. The Media Room terminal audit shows me revising that very file throughout the poisoning window. I was covering up a professional humiliation, not a murder.

#### **IF MURDERER**

Sterling had enough money to survive any mistake. He wanted mine to destroy me instead. I went back with the appraisal folder, poisoned his silver coupe, and relied on one true fact - that I had already touched a lookalike decanter - to muddy the rest. In my business, provenance is everything. Tonight I created my own missing gap.